Harris County District Court

Cause No. 2023-CV-0047

Jessica Olson, Plaintiff, v. Harbor Point Mutual Auto Insurance, Defendant

Oral Deposition of Jessica Olson

Date:	January 3, 2024
Location:	Offices of Valentine & Joyce Injury Lawyers
Examining attorney:	Marilyn Fox, Ashford & Lyle LLP
Defending attorney:	Lisa Solis, Valentine & Joyce Injury Lawyers

Q: Please state your full name for the record.

A: I'd rather not give my full name on the record, but my attorney has confirmed the caption, so you can use the name listed on the case.

Q: Fair enough. Let's go over the accident itself. Where were you when it happened?

A: I was driving on a two-lane road in Baytown, Texas, heading home from work. It was late afternoon and the traffic was light.

Q: What were you doing right before the collision?

A: I was going about thirty miles an hour in my lane. I had just come around a slight curve when I saw the other car drifting into my lane.

Q: Did you have time to react?

A: Not really. I hit the brakes and turned the wheel a little, but the impact happened almost right away. It wasn't a big crash, but it was a head-on hit.

Q: Who was driving the other vehicle?

A: A woman. She was apologizing at the scene. She said she looked down at her phone for a second.

Q: Did you feel any pain at the scene?

A: Not immediately. I felt shaken up and my neck felt stiff, but I told the officer I was okay. Within a few hours it got much worse.

Q: Let's talk about treatment. Who did you see first after the accident?

A: I went to the emergency room that night because my neck was really sore and I had headaches. They took X-rays and gave me a neck brace and some pain medication.

Q: After the emergency room, what treatment did you receive?

A: My primary care doctor referred me to a physical therapist. I've been going two or three times a week. I also have a follow-up scheduled with a specialist.

Q: How has your daily life changed since the accident?

A: It's harder to sleep. Turning my head to check my blind spot when I drive is painful, so I've had to rely on mirrors more. I also used to coach my son's youth soccer team, and I've had to step back from that because I can't demonstrate drills or stay on my feet as long.

Q: Have you missed any work?

A: I've missed a few days, and some days I've worked with restrictions. Lifting boxes at my job is difficult now.

Q: Before this accident, did you have any prior neck or back problems?

A: No, nothing serious. I had occasional stiffness from sitting at a desk, but nothing that required a doctor.